INSTRUCTOR COPY **Cryptography All-in-One: TEACHER VERSION**

This is the pupil booklet with the lesson timeline added (this page) and the answers filled in, in **red**. Page numbers match the pupil booklet (page 1 is its cover). Pupils never see this version.

Timeline 90 minutes: what happens when

minutes	activity	slides	resource
0–10	**Talk.** Hook: encoding, you already do it, why compress, what RLE is. Skim 3 to 5, 8 and 10 if short of time.	1–11	slides
10–12	**Worked example.** Decode the first picture together on the board.	12–13	slides
12–22	**Pupils, by hand.** Warm-up rows, mystery 1, mystery 2 (3 and 4 are stretch).	14	booklet pp. 2–5
22–32	**Talk.** Quick answer check, then "that took a while": a row is a list, a picture is a list of rows, `show_picture` and the heart (live in Spyder), decoding one row.	15–16, 21–33	slides, Spyder live
32–37	**Pupils.** Open Spyder, run the starter (Task 1), trace a row on paper, plan in English.	41	booklet pp. 6–8, code
37–42	**Talk.** `.append`, a loop inside a loop, the shape of `decode_row`.	34–37	slides
42–57	**Pupils, code.** Write `decode_row` and test it on `[2, 7, 3]` (Task 2). Hints in layers.	36–37, 41	booklet p. 9, code
57–60	**Talk.** One clue becomes a row, so many clues become a picture: `decode_picture`.	38–40	slides
60–75	**Pupils, code.** Write `decode_picture`, show the first picture (Task 3), then the big pictures (Task 4).	41	booklet pp. 10–11, code
75–80	**Talk.** The finished product: the same code on much bigger pictures. Show what the plots should look like.	44–50	slides
80–88	**Pupils.** Time the big pictures, compare with by hand (Task 5). **Stretch:** `encode_row`, Encode it.	43	booklet pp. 11–12
88–90	**Recap.** What you learned: encoding, compression, RLE, loops and functions.	51–52	slides

Notes For the teacher

- **It is tight.** The code is the point: if the by-hand block overruns, stop it at 22 minutes. Mystery 3 and 4 are for fast finishers, and answers are on slides 17 to 20.
- **Pupils working ahead are fine.** The booklet has every instruction and three layers of hints, so pupils can move on while you talk to others. Do not wait for the slowest pair before each talk: keep talks to the minutes above.
- **Common slips:** swapping the colour inside the inner loop (stripes), a missing `return` (prints `None`), `append` indented in the wrong loop. Answers: `worksheets/teacher/Cryptography-All-in-One-answers.pdf`.
- **Assessment:** watch Task 2 working (`decode_row` on `[2, 7, 3]`) and ask how the swap works. Task 5 times and the written reasons on booklet page 11 show understanding of why computers help.

Cryptography Challenge

Run-length encoding: decode pictures by hand, then teach Python to do it.

Name: _____

Class: _____

Date: _____

Today What we are doing

what we do	booklet
Listen: what is encoding, and why do computers compress data?	
Watch: decode the first picture together	
By hand: shade pictures from their clues	pages 2 to 4 (5 if you finish)
Listen: how could a computer do this for us?	
Spyder: run the starter code, trace a row on paper	pages 6 to 8
Listen: `.append` and a loop inside a loop	
Code: write `decode_row`	page 9
Listen: now a whole picture	
Code: write `decode_picture`, then the big pictures	pages 10 and 11
Listen: the finished product	
Code: how fast is the computer? Stretch tasks	pages 11 and 12
Recap: what you learned today	

How it works Use this booklet your way

- Work at **your own speed**. When your teacher is talking, pens and keyboards down and listen.
- Pages 2 to 5 are **by hand** (pencil). Pages 6 to 12 use **Spyder**. Pages 13 and 14 are for reference.
- **Stuck?** Read Hint 1, try again. Then Hint 2, try again. Then Hint 3. Then ask.
- **Ahead of the class?** Keep going. The stretch tasks are on pages 5 and 12.
- **Answers** are on the last page, upside down. Try first, then check.
- **Missed the talk, or want the ideas again?** Pages 13 and 14 explain encoding, lists, loops and a worked example (the heart).

My progress ☐ by hand (2 to 4) ☐ Task 1 ☐ Task 2 ☐ Task 3 ☐ Task 4 ☐ Task 5 ☐ stretch

PART 1 BY HAND

about 3 min

Warm-up: rows

Clue = blanks, coloured, blanks, . . . Shade the boxes with a pencil.

A Decode the rows

Example: `2, 7, 3` means 2 blank, 7 coloured, 3 blank.

2, 7, 3



Your turn. (0 first = starts coloured)

3, 5, 4



0, 4, 8



1, 2, 2, 2, 5



6, 6



0, 3, 3, 3, 3



B Squash it

Write each string as a clue: count each run, then the letter.

`AAAABBBCCCCD` → 4A 3B 4C 1D

`WWWWWWBBW` → 6W 2B 1W

`XXXXXXXXXX` → 10X

C Stretch it

`4C 2A 5B` → C C C C A A B B B B B

`3X 1Y 2Z` → X X X Y Z Z

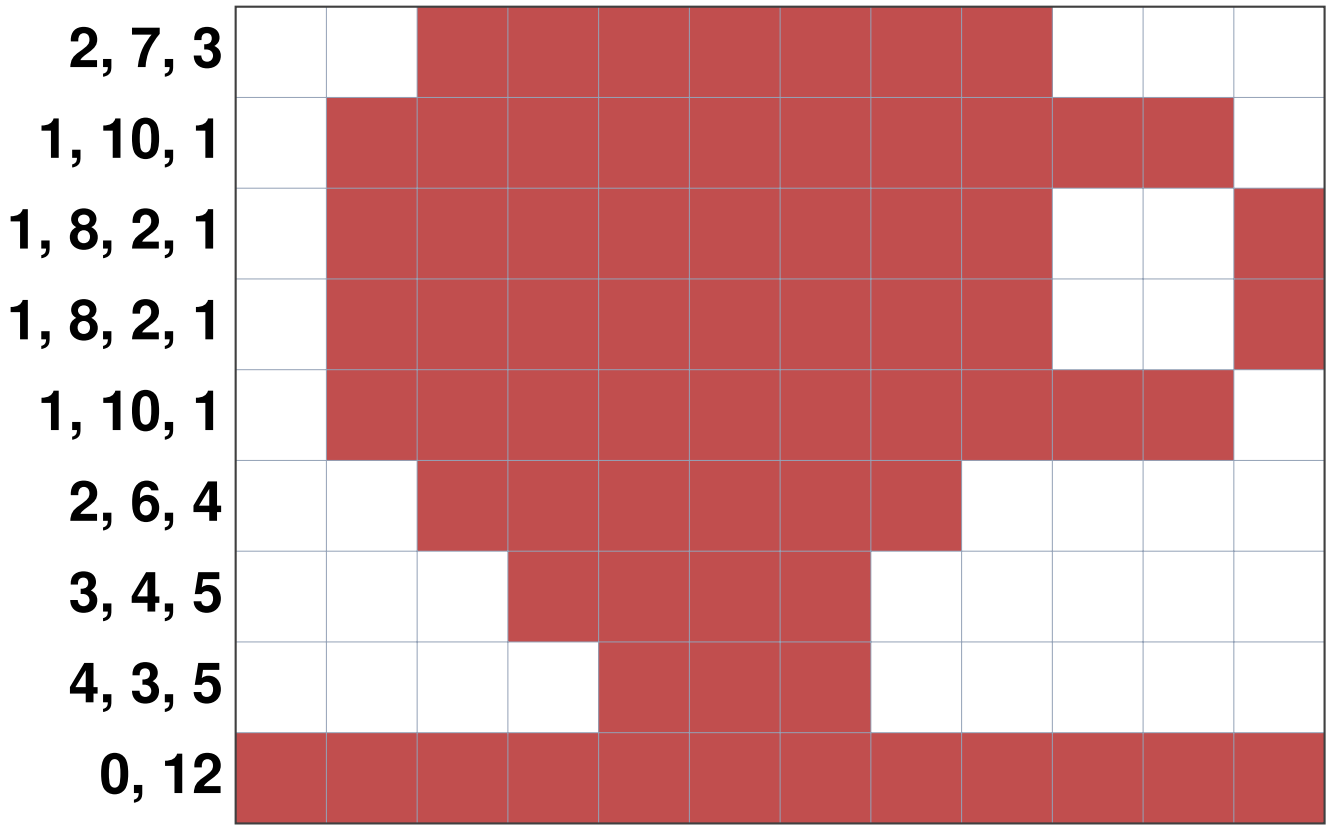
`1A 1B 1A 1B 1A` → A B A B A

PART 1 BY HAND

about 4 min

Mystery picture 1

Shade the coloured pixels. Clue = blanks, coloured, blanks, . . .



Tip: a clue that starts with `0` means the row starts coloured. Every row's numbers add up to 12.

What is it? _____

How long did it take? _____ min

ANSWER Mystery picture 1 is a **mug**. Every row adds up to 12.

PART 1 BY HAND

about 3 min

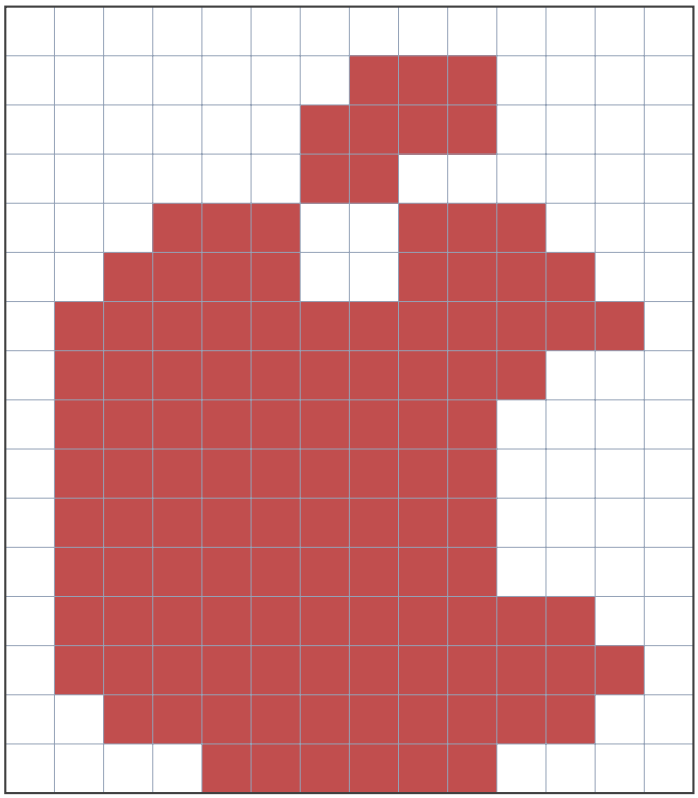
Mystery pictures 2 and 3

Do 2 first. Do 3 if you have time. Each row adds up to 14.

Mystery picture 2

What is it? _____

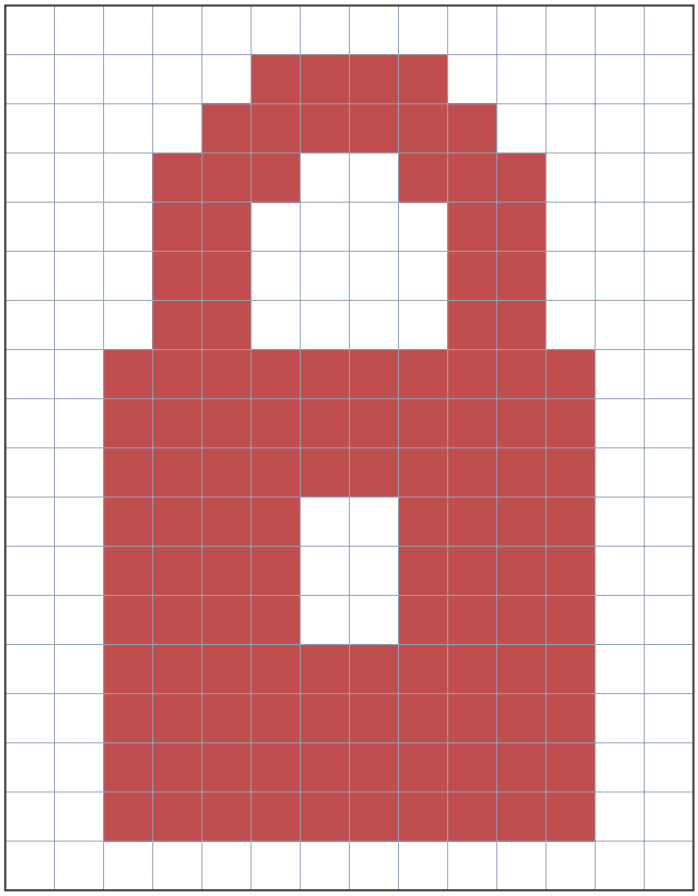
14
7, 3, 4
6, 4, 4
6, 2, 6
3, 3, 2, 3, 3
2, 4, 2, 4, 2
1, 12, 1
1, 10, 3
1, 9, 4
1, 9, 4
1, 9, 4
1, 9, 4
1, 11, 2
1, 12, 1
2, 10, 2
4, 6, 4



Mystery picture 3

What is it? _____

14
5, 4, 5
4, 6, 4
3, 3, 2, 3, 3
3, 2, 4, 2, 3
3, 2, 4, 2, 3
3, 2, 4, 2, 3
2, 10, 2
2, 10, 2
2, 10, 2
2, 4, 2, 4, 2
2, 4, 2, 4, 2
2, 4, 2, 4, 2
2, 10, 2
2, 10, 2
2, 10, 2
2, 10, 2
14

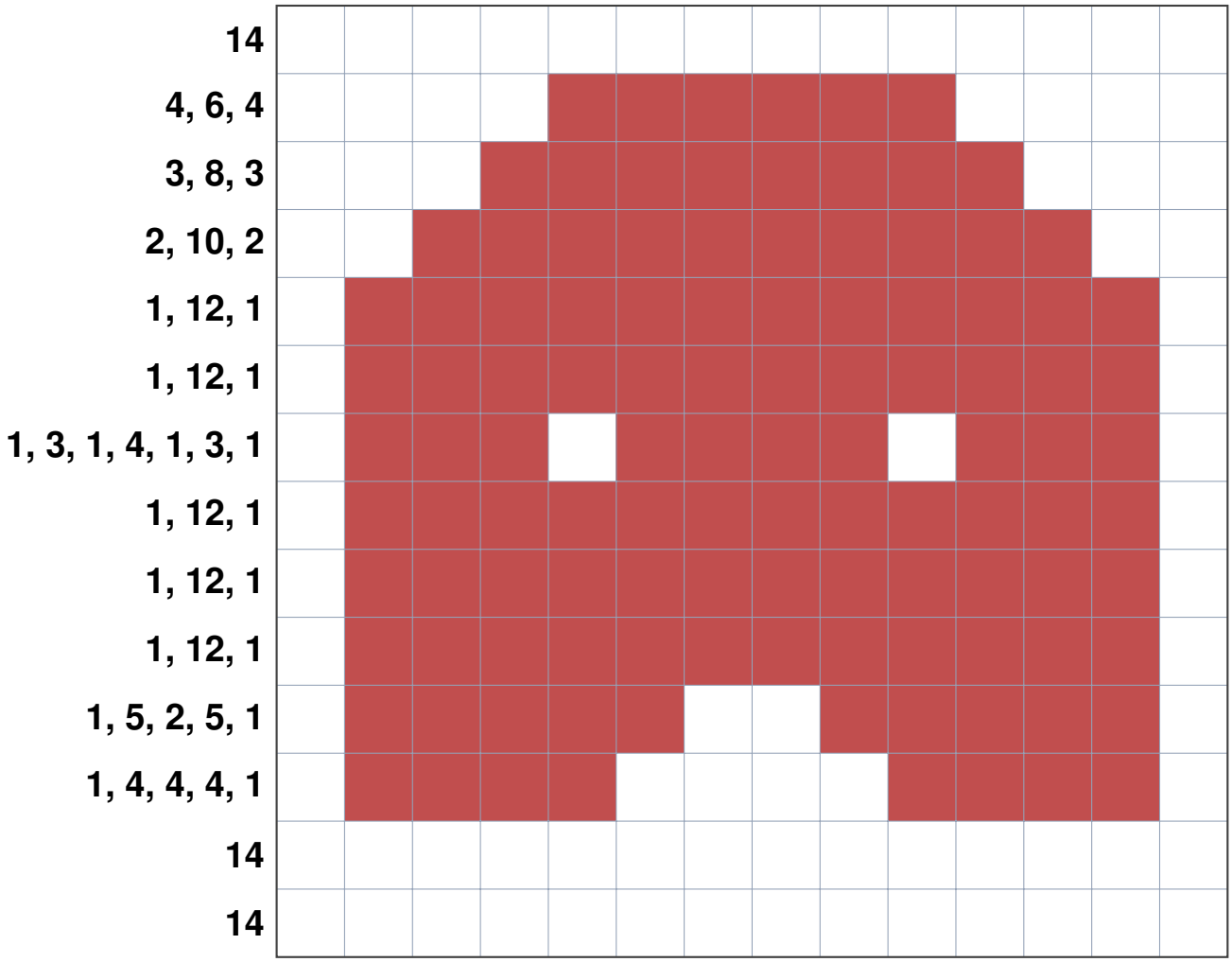


ANSWER Mystery picture 2 is the **Apple logo**. Mystery picture 3 is a **padlock**.

if you finish early

Mystery picture 4

Finished early? Shade this one and answer the pattern questions.



? Spot the pattern

1. Which rows have the same clue? Rows _____ and _____

2. Which row is the widest (most coloured pixels)? Row _____

3. What do you notice about the left and right sides of the picture?

ANSWER Same clue: rows 1 and 13 and 14; rows 5 and 6 and 8 and 9 and 10. Widest row: row 5, 6, 8, 9, 10. Left and right: the picture is a mirror image (every row reads the same backwards).

PART 2 SPYDER

about 2 min

Get Python ready

Do each step, then tick the box.

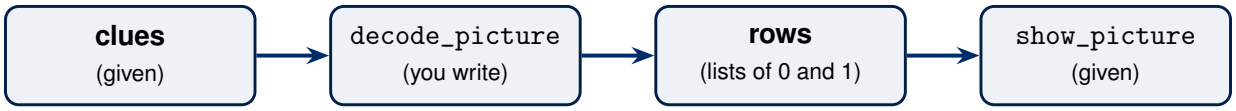
1. **Open Spyder.**
2. **Open the file** `rle_starter.py` . Your teacher will tell you which folder it is in: _____
3. **Check** `pictures.py` is in the *same* folder. You never change that file.
4. **Run it:** press the green triangle (or **F5**).
5. **Look at the Plots pane.** You should see a heart made of dark and blank squares.

☐ **Task 1 done:** I can see the heart.

Check: a heart in the Plots pane. No heart? `pictures.py` **is in a different folder, or the Plots pane is hidden (View, Panes, Plots).**

Remember How the computer sees a picture

- A **row** is a list of 0s and 1s: `row = [0, 0, 1, 1, 1, 0]` . 0 = blank, 1 = coloured.
- A **picture** is a list of rows.
- A **clue** is a list of numbers: blanks, coloured, blanks, . . .
  `[2, 7, 3]` becomes `[0, 0, 1, 1, 1, 1, 1, 1, 1, 0, 0, 0]` .



Tasks Your five tasks for today

task	what to do	page	done
1	`rle_starter.py` : run it, see the heart	6	☐
2	finish `decode_row` , test it on `[2, 7, 3]`	9	☐
3	finish `decode_picture` , show the picture from Mystery 1	10	☐
4	`mystery_image_5` , `mystery_image_6` , then `mystery_image_7`	11	☐
5	`mystery_image_7` : how long by hand? How long by computer?	11	☐

PART 2 PAPER FIRST

about 2 min

Be the computer

Follow the code one step at a time. Fill in every empty box.

A Trace `decode_row([2, 7, 3])`

Start: `row = []` `colour = 0`. Step 1 is done for you.

step	number	colour	what gets added	row so far
1	2	0	`0, 0`	`[0, 0]`
2	7	**1**	**1 seven times**	`[0, 0, 1, 1, 1, 1, 1, 1, 1]`
3	3	**0**	**0 three times**	`[0, 0, 1, 1, 1, 1, 1, 1, 1, 0, 0, 0]`

B A clue that starts with 0

Trace `decode_row([0, 4, 2])`. Fill in the rest.

step	number	colour	what gets added	row so far
1	0	0	**nothing**	`[]`
2	4	**1**	**1 four times**	`[1, 1, 1, 1]`
3	2	**0**	**0 twice**	`[1, 1, 1, 1, 0, 0]`

? What is different about the first step?

`range(0)` **runs zero times, so nothing is added, but the colour still swaps. The row starts with 1.**

What does `colour = 1 - colour` **do?** Try `colour = 0`, then `colour = 1`.

It flips the colour: 0 becomes 1 and 1 becomes 0 ($1 - 0 = 1$ and $1 - 1 = 0$).

PART 2 PLAN

about 1 min

Plan before you type

Write the steps in plain English first. No code yet!

A Steps for `decode_row`

Write the steps the function follows, one per line.

Word bank: start • for each number • add • swap colour • return

1. **Start with an empty row and colour 0.**
2. **For each number in the clue:**
3. **add that many copies of colour to the row**
4. **swap colour (0 to 1, 1 to 0)**
5. **return the row**

B Steps for `decode_picture`

Same again, for a whole picture.

1. **Start with an empty picture.**
2. **For each clue: decode it into a row**
3. **add the row to the picture**
4. **return the picture**

Compare with your trace on page 7: does your plan match what you did by hand? Stuck? Page 14 plans the heart the same way.

PART 3 CODE

about 15 min

Task 2: decode_row

Finish the function, run the file, check the test.

```
def decode_row(clue):
    row = []        # the row we are building. It starts empty.
    colour = 0      # we always start with blanks (0)

    # go through each number in the clue (a for loop over the list)
    for number in clue:
```

Model answer

```
    for number in clue:
        for i in range(number):
            row.append(colour)
        colour = 1 - colour
```

```
    return row      # what do we give back?
```

`print(decode_row([2, 7, 3]))` expected: `[0, 0, 1, 1, 1, 1, 1, 1, 1, 0, 0, 0]`

What did YOU get? _____ ☐ it matches

Hint 1: the idea

You need a loop inside a loop (page 13 shows one). The outer loop picks each number from the clue. The inner loop repeats that many times.

Hint 2: the pieces

The inner loop is `for i in range(number):` and each time round it does `row.append(colour)`. After the inner loop finishes, swap the colour: `colour = 1 - colour` (or an if / else).

Hint 3: the shape (fill in the gaps)

```
for number in clue:
    for i in range(number):
        row.append(colour)      # add colour to the row
    colour = 1 - colour          # swap the colour (level with the inner for)
```

Nothing printed, or `None`? Check `return row` is at the very end, level with the first `for`.

☐ **Task 2 done:** my `decode_row` gives the right answer for `[2, 7, 3]`.

PART 3 CODE

about 8 min

Task 3: decode_picture

Reuse your row decoder to decode a whole picture.

```
def decode_picture(clues):
    picture = []   # the picture we are building. It starts empty.

    # go through each clue in clues:
    #   1. decode that clue into a row (use your function!)
    #   2. add the row to the picture   hint: picture.append(...)

    return picture
```

Model answer

```
    for clue in clues:
        row = decode_row(clue)
        picture.append(row)
```

Test it: `show_picture(decode_picture(mystery_image_1))` (take the `#` off the line in the starter file)

Does the picture in the Plots pane match your Mystery picture 1? ☐ yes ☐ not yet

Hint 1: the idea

A picture is many rows. You already have a function that turns one clue into one row. Use it once for every clue.

Hint 2: the pieces

Loop over `clues`. Inside the loop: `row = decode_row(clue)`, then `picture.append(row)`.

Hint 3: the shape (fill in the gaps)

```
for clue in clues:
    row = decode_row(clue)
    picture.append(row)
```

Empty picture? Check `return picture` is at the very end, level with the first `for`.

Debugging checklist

- ☐ Did I put `return` at the end, indented once?
- ☐ Is my colour swap INSIDE the outer loop but AFTER the inner loop?
- ☐ Is my `append` indented inside the loop it belongs to?
- ☐ Did I run the file again (F5) after changing it?

☐ **Task 3 done:** my code draws the picture from Mystery 1.

about 15 min

Tasks 4 and 5: the finished product

Same code. Much bigger pictures. Then time it.

Task 4 Run your code on the big ones

Take the `#` off these lines in the starter file, one at a time, and run it. Tick each when it works.

```
show_picture(decode_picture(mystery_image_5))  # [ ] worked
show_picture(decode_picture(mystery_image_6))  # [ ] worked
show_picture(decode_picture(mystery_image_7))  # [ ] worked (the one that took ages by hand!)
```

Did your code have to change? ☐ yes ☐ no **(no: that is the point)**

Task 5 How long does each way take?

picture	rows	did it work?	time by computer	time by hand
Mystery 1	9			min (page 3)
`mystery_image_5`	47	**yes**	**about 1 s**	
`mystery_image_6`	32	**yes**	**about 1 s**	
`mystery_image_7`	46	**yes**	**about 1 s**	my guess: min

Estimate it. Mystery 1 took me _____ min. `mystery_image_7` has about 5 times as many rows (46 compared with 9), and its rows are longer. So by hand it would take me at least _____ × 5 = _____ min.

Which is faster for the biggest picture, you or Python? Why?
Python, by far (about a second against many minutes by hand). The same loops do the same job however many rows there are, and the computer never gets tired or loses its place.

Think: what if the picture was a photo with a million rows? What would you do?
Let the computer do it: write the decoding once and the loop repeats it a million times. By hand it would be impossible.

Want to race the computer? Ask your teacher for a big grid to shade by hand while your code runs.

☐ **Task 4 done** ☐ **Task 5 done**

PART 4 STRETCH

stretch

Go backwards: encode_row

Row in, clue out. For when your decoder works and you want more.

```
def encode_row(row):
    clue = []
    # count how many pixels in a row are the same, and add each count to clue.
    return clue

print(encode_row([0, 0, 1, 1, 1, 1, 1, 1, 1, 0, 0, 0]))   # should print [2, 7, 3]
```

Model answer

```
colour = 0
count = 0
for pixel in row:
    if pixel == colour:
        count += 1
    else:
        clue.append(count)
        colour = pixel
        count = 1
clue.append(count)
```

Hint 1: the idea

Start by counting blanks (0). Keep two variables: `colour` (starts at 0) and `count` (starts at 0). Loop over every pixel in the row.

Hint 2: the pieces

If the pixel is the same as `colour`, do `count += 1`. Otherwise: add `count` to `clue`, change `colour` to the new pixel, and start counting again at 1.

Hint 3: the easy-to-forget bit

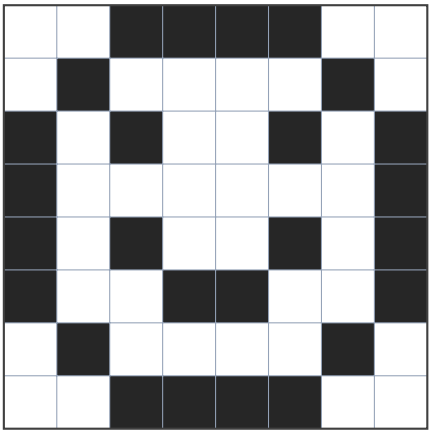
When the loop ends, the last run of pixels has not been added to `clue` yet. Add it before you `return`.

By hand Encode it

Write each row's clue in its box. Blanks first, then coloured (start with `0` if the row starts coloured).

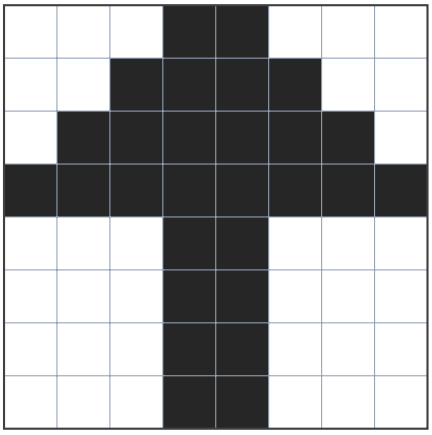
Picture A

2, 4, 2	
1, 1, 4, 1, 1	
0, 1, 1, 1, 2, 1, 1, 1	
0, 1, 6, 1	
0, 1, 1, 1, 2, 1, 1, 1	
0, 1, 2, 2, 2, 1	
1, 1, 4, 1, 1	
2, 4, 2	



Picture B

3, 2, 3	
2, 4, 2	
1, 6, 1	
0, 8	
3, 2, 3	
3, 2, 3	
3, 2, 3	
3, 2, 3	



Think: would clues save more space on a picture with lots of single dots, or with big solid blocks?

Solid blocks: single dots give runs of 1, so the clue is no shorter.

Keep going: design your own picture and clues, and swap with a partner. Ask your teacher for the Design your own sheet.

reference

The ideas you need

Missed the talk? Read this first. Come back to it whenever you are stuck.

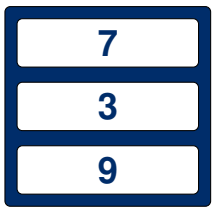
A Encoding, compression and run-length encoding

Encoding means writing the same information a different way (text as numbers, a picture as a grid of numbers). **Compression** is encoding with a goal: say the same thing in fewer symbols. **Run-length encoding (RLE)** stores *what repeats* and *how many times*:

`AAAABBBCCCCD` becomes `4A 3B 4C 1D`

In a picture, every row is blanks, then coloured, then blanks, and so on. So a row of 12 squares can be just three numbers: `[2, 7, 3]` means 2 blank, 7 coloured, 3 blank. It works well on pictures with big blocks of one colour and badly on pictures where every pixel is different.

B Lists: a filing cabinet



A **list** is like a filing cabinet. Each drawer holds one thing, and the drawers are in order.

```
numbers = [7, 3, 9]
```

A list can hold *other lists*: a filing cabinet whose drawers each hold a smaller filing cabinet.

```
grid = [[1, 2, 3], [4, 5, 6], [7, 8, 9]]
```

So a **row** is a list of 0s and 1s, and a **picture** is a list of rows (a list of lists).

C .append and a loop inside a loop

`row.append(0)` sticks one more thing on the end of the list `row`. `for number in clue:` does the indented lines once for each number in `clue`. `for i in range(3):` does them 3 times.

```
row = []
for number in [2, 3]:            # outer loop: one pass for each number
    for i in range(number):      # inner loop: repeat that many times
        row.append(0)
print(row)                       # [0, 0, 0, 0, 0]
```

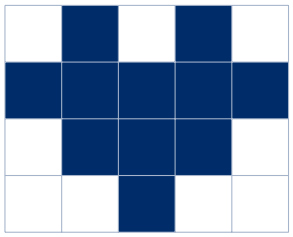
Look for the shape. The inner loop is indented one step more than the outer loop. Anything you want to do once per number (not once per square) goes in the outer loop *after* the inner loop.

reference

Worked example: the heart

One whole decode, planned in plain English and then traced step by step.

A The picture and its clues



row	clue	row as a list
1	`1, 1, 1, 1, 1`	`[0, 1, 0, 1, 0]`
2	`0, 5`	`[1, 1, 1, 1, 1]`
3	`1, 3, 1`	`[0, 1, 1, 1, 0]`
4	`2, 1, 2`	`[0, 0, 1, 0, 0]`

Row 2 starts with `0`: zero blanks, so the row starts coloured. Our job is to go from the clue back to the row.

B Plan it in pseudocode

```
picture = empty list
FOR each clue in the clues:                <- outer loop: one row at a time
    row = empty list
    colour = 0   (blank)
    FOR each number in the clue:           <- inner loop: one number at a time
        add that many of colour to the row
        swap colour   (0 to 1, 1 to 0)
    add the row to the picture
RETURN the picture
```

C Step through row 3: the clue `[1, 3, 1]`

number	colour	add to the row	row so far
start	0	nothing	`[ ]`
1	0	`[0]`	`[0]`
3	1	`[1, 1, 1]`	`[0, 1, 1, 1]`
1	0	`[0]`	`[0, 1, 1, 1, 0]`

Colour is swapped after each number. The finished row is row 3 of the heart. Now the *outer* loop does the same for each of the four clues and adds each row to the picture. **Outer loop: one row at a time. Inner loop: one number at a time.**